

downloaded from www.asterisk.org/downloads. For a few distributions like Debian and Ubuntu, Asterisk is available as a package with pre-compiled binaries ready for installation. On other distributions, you can download the source code but need to compile and install it. Follow the instructions and proceed with the installation as guided by the package manager.

Installing Asterisk in Debian and Ubuntu from the repository

Step 1: Update your system using this command:

```
apt-get update
```

Step 2: Installing Asterisk from the repository should resolve all the dependencies:

```
apt-get install asterisk
```

How to install Asterisk in any Linux distribution from source code

Step 1: Download Asterisk:

```
wget http://downloads.asterisk.org/pub/telephony/asterisk/releases/asterisk-1.8.tar.gz
```

Step 2: Extract the source using gunzip:

```
tar xzvf asterisk-1.8.tar.gz
```

Step 3: Install the dependency libraries *build-essential*, *libxml2-dev* and *ncurses-dev* from the repository:

```
apt-get install build-essential libxml2-dev ncurses-dev
```

Step 4: Run the series of commands to configure, compile and install Asterisk:

```
cd asterisk-1.8.3/
./configure
make
make install
make config
make samples
```

Successful installation will show an Asterisk daemon running in the background, which can be tested using a simple command like `ps -ef | grep "asterisk"`

After successful installation, you can check the

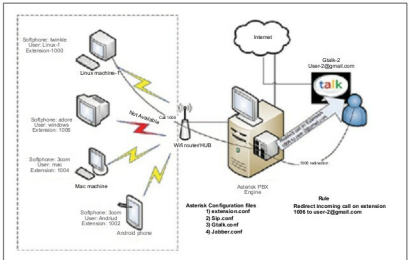


Figure 4: Softphone to Gtalk call flow



Figure 5: Extension.conf

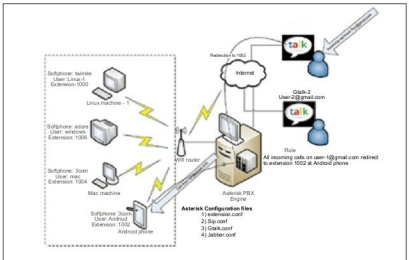


Figure 6: Call flow - Gtalk to softphone

Asterisk console with the command `"asterisk -r"` with super user privileges.

Let us now look into the implementation of the PBX with the help of softphones to avoid special hardware requirements as much as possible. This will also be a significant cost saving (refer to the case studies and the 'Hardphone vs Softphone' section). Since the cost of IP phones accounts for around 40 per cent of VoIP projects, there is the option to use either softphones or low cost USB IP phones, according to your budget.

Configuration

After installing Asterisk on the PC, we need to configure the